



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Christ's Legacy Academy

School Website: <https://www.christslegacyacademy.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Christ's Legacy Academy (CLA) in Athens, TN presents a clearly Christian and classical orientation, underpinned by explicit commitments to Trivium-based learning (grammar, logic, rhetoric), a biblically-centered worldview, and robust partnership with families. Public materials from CLA emphasize a biblical foundation, discipleship, and a mission to form character and wisdom in students within a classical framework. The school's public materials also showcase a strong faculty and community orientation, including staff biographies and a stated mission to partner with families in the formation of students. However, while the institution foregrounds classical language (Trivium) and covenantal, biblical aims, explicit references to several canonical classical components (notably Great Books/Great Conversation and certain contemplative pedagogies that frequently characterize classical schools) are less evident in the public content. On balance, CLA demonstrates a solid classical Christian orientation, with stronger evidence in religious foundations and mission/community, and more modest explicit alignment in some curricular/educational-method facets.

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

- The strongest evidence lies in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, Faculty, and Parents & Community, where explicit references to God, Scripture, discipleship, Trivium, and partnership with families are visible. See the CLA Distinctives (mission, vision, theology, and classical approach) and the articulation of Trivium-based learning as core to the program.
- The Curriculum and Pedagogy dimensions show clear classical scaffolding (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric), but explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and some traditional pedagogical practices (e.g., Socratic seminars, memory work, scholé) are not consistently foregrounded in the public material. This leads to a category reading of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for those areas.
- The Faculty and Parents & Community categories show strong alignment with the classical model and a robust, forming partnership with families, which supports a CLASSICAL reading for those areas.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Below, each category is analyzed in detail with keyword-driven reasoning and a concluding rating, followed by a "What would move the needle" section for the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL areas. Citations point to the primary public materials from CLA, and to the classical-education keyword lexicon used to ground the evaluation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Details

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a theologically grounded mission and worldview. Primary statements emphasize partnership with families to educate students to think and live for God's glory, i.e., a transcendent aim tied to virtue and truth in a biblical frame. - Authority of Scripture is explicit: "The foundation for all we teach and do is the inerrant, infallible, authoritative Word of God" and "All Scripture is God-breathed." These quotations anchor moral realism and theological grounding in the public materials. - The school articulates a discipleship model and a preeminent Christology within a classical framework, reinforcing a sacramental/theological orientation and a liturgical-leaning sense of formation within community. - The Vision and Mission foreground biblical literacy, Scripture-informed discernment, and a God-centered telos for students.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators found (examples from public materials): God, glory to God, biblical worldview, Scripture, Word of God, inerrant/infallible Word of God, discipleship, Christ, pre-eminence of Christ, theology. Across the sources, roughly 7–8 distinct positive signals are evident (e.g., "biblical worldview," "Authority of Scripture," "Trivium" as a core framework, "Discipleship Model"). - Negative indicators: None of the negative signals from the lexicon (e.g., secular humanism, relativism, values clarification) are present in the public materials. The content is consistently theologically anchored rather than secular. The classical lexicon's negative signals are not evidenced here.

Why this rating - The explicit theological framing, scriptural authority, and discipleship orientation align strongly with the RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS criteria of a classical school. The absence of any secular competing claims or explicit relativistic messaging further supports a CLASSICAL designation for this category. The presence of the Trivium in their classical approach further anchors this category in a traditional classical frame.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize formation and character in a classical, biblical frame rather than mere information transfer. Phrases such as "form a biblical worldview," "disciple students," and a mission to develop discernment and godly thinking appear in the school's stated aims. - The Mission emphasizes forming students to think and engage the world for God's glory in a classical, well-formed manner, with emphasis on virtue-informed thinking and moral formation. The Vision speaks to discerning thinking and articulacy within Scriptural framing. - The presence of "classical" phrasing—i.e., "classically educate" and "classical approach"—demonstrates an orientation toward paideia and virtue education rather than solely job-readiness or information delivery.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators observed: formation, virtue (implied via discipleship and godly formation), wisdom (implied via discernment and thoughtful reasoning), liberal education and classical mission (explicit CLA language). The materials repeatedly frame education as formation and worldview-building rather than purely technical job-readiness. The explicit "classically educate" language supports alignment with the classical mission. - Negative indicators: The materials do not emphasize workforce readiness, 21st-century skills, or career-preparatory language in a direct sense; however, explicit references to the Great Books/Great Conversation are not strong in the public materials. This reduces the degree to which all standard "purpose-and-goal" markers are affirmed. From the lexicon, the strongest negatives would be workforce-focused rhetoric, which is not present.

Why this rating - The school's stated aims clearly align with formation and virtue-oriented education consistent with classical ideals; however, there is less explicit articulation of the full spectrum of classical purpose markers (e.g., explicit paideia framework, explicit Great Books/Great Conversation phrasing). The result is a strong classical orientation in purpose but not a fully explicit articulation across all the canonical markers, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly identifies the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as foundational, and public content repeatedly describes a Trivium-based structure and a classical curriculum. This aligns with core classical-C Christian curriculum norms. - The materials indicate a history- and Classics-forward framing through the Trivium, but explicit reference to Great Books, primary sources, or the Great Conversation is not strongly evident in the public content. The curriculum is described as classical and Trinity-based, but not all canonical elements (e.g., Great Books, direct call-outs to classical literature) are clearly present in the public pages provided. - The school emphasizes a biblical, integrated curriculum and a Trivium structure rather than a purely modern, standardized curriculum. This shows alignment with classical pedagogy and content in many respects.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), classical approach, grammar/logic/rhetoric as core, history integrated with classical pedagogy (evident in the structure and language around Trivium). The public materials support a classical curricular orientation through explicit Trivium framing. - Negative indicators: Absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation references; limited explicit mention of a classical canon of Great Books in the public content. The lexicon flags Great Books/Great Conversation as key positive signals for a full classical curriculum; their explicit mention is not evident in the public CLA crawl content.

Why this rating - The curriculum is clearly grounded in classical/trivium-based design, which is a strong classical criterion. However, the lack of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation references in the public site content (as captured) means the curriculum is robustly classical in structure but not fully demonstrated across all canonical markers in the available materials. This supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for the Curriculum category.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The program explicitly highlights a Trivium-based pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric) which implies a mix of memorization (grammar stage), reasoning (logic stage), and oratory/writing (rhetoric stage) across grade levels. This aligns with classical pedagogy fundamentals. - The public content references upper-level rhetoric training and expected rhetoric output (e.g., “logic and rhetoric in all subjects” and the emphasis on critical thinking and reasoning). The exact phrasing about Socratic seminars or seminars/debates is not consistently explicit, though the pedagogical direction suggests a classical orientation in higher grades. - Lower-school pedagogy in public content is less explicit about contemplative or restful approaches and about singing/chanting/memory work (which are common features of scholé in many classical programs). The explicit mentions of singing/reminiscent memory in lower grades are less visible in CLA’s public pages, though the broader “living curriculum” framing exists in the governance material.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: Trivium framing; rhetoric training in upper grades; pivotal classical pedagogy concepts such as memory, recitation, and disciplined reasoning are suggested by the overall classical approach and job postings that emphasize professional development and classical formation. - Negative indicators: Direct mentions of contemplative/scholé rest or singing/chanting in lower grades are not clearly evidenced in the public crawl; explicit statements about Socratic seminars or regular Socratic discourse in the upper school are not strongly visible in the crawl content. The presence of a strong classical approach exists, but the explicit pedagogy signals typically associated with scholé and contemplative/restful learning are not clearly documented in the public content.

Why this rating - The pedagogy is solidly classical in its Trivium orientation and rhetoric emphasis, but the absence of explicit, consistently documented contemplative/restful pedagogy (scholé), formal Socratic seminars, and explicit lower-to-upper-school contemplative practices in the crawl content keeps this category from a full CLASSICAL rating. The evidence places CLA in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL category for Pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe faculty in terms of virtue, mentorship, and living curriculum, with a strong expectation that teachers model virtue and that they form a core of the school community. The “distinctives” language emphasizes the teacher as a central role in classical formation and a relationship-based “living curriculum.” - Job postings and staff biographies describe teachers as professionals who align with a Christian, classical approach and “coach and nurture” other staff; there are explicit mentions of character and Christ-like behavior, which reinforces the classical faculty profile. - The school emphasizes the faculty as mentors and the “portrait of a teacher” that frames expectations for teacher conduct and formation, aligning with the classical model of teachers as the living curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators found: living curriculum, faculty as mentors, portrait of teacher/student ideals, Christ-centered professionalism, collaboration and collegiality (as implied by staff development and teamwork). The CLA materials frequently use language that positions teachers as moral exemplars and central to formation. - Negative indicators: No clear negative signals; the materials do not present anti-classical pedagogy or anti-classical staff models. The lexicon’s negative signals (e.g., “facilitators” on the side, purely certification-driven jargon) are not evident in the CLA materials; rather, there is emphasis on character and formation.

Why this rating - The faculty portrayal as mentors, exemplars, and “living curriculum” strongly aligns with classical tradition. The combination of mission-driven staff expectations and Christ-centered teacher formation supports a CLASSICAL designation for the Faculty category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - CLA emphasizes partnership with families as co-educators and as central to classical education: “We partner with families to classically educate students,” and “parents as co-teachers in the school,” with explicit calls for parent formation and engagement through resources (web content, book discussions, gatherings) and open-campus visitation. - The school communicates a philosophy of involving parents in the formation process and providing mutual education about classical education; there are explicit mentions of parent involvement and home-school alignment. - The school highlights welcoming parents and ongoing engagement with families through enrollment processes, family interviews, and opportunities to participate, which aligns with classical community expectations.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators observed: partnership with families, parents as co-teachers, parent formation (book studies, gatherings), open campus/visits, home-school alignment. The lexicon’s positive keywords for this category (Partnership with Families, Formation, Cultural Transmission) align well with CLA language. - Negative indicators: No explicit consumerist framing or minimal parent involvement; the materials emphasize active parental involvement. The presence of open, cooperative parent/community engagement supports a positive signal without any negative signals evident in the crawl.

Why this rating - The school clearly positions parents as co-educators and emphasizes family partnership and parental formation, aligning strongly with CLASSICAL values in the Parents & Community category.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal): Introduce explicit, language-forward articulation of virtuous formation (virtue, wisdom, telos) and connect those terms to a clearly stated paideia framework beyond “classical” branding. Publish a succinct statement listing the exact classical aims (e.g., formation, pursuit of truth/beauty/goodness) with explicit references to classical virtues.
- Element 3 (Curriculum): Add explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language and commitments to studying canonical texts and primary sources alongside the Trivium structure. Include a public-facing

articulation of core canonical texts and a short justification for their role in Western civilization and Christian thought to strengthen the map of the curriculum.

- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Document and publish explicit use of Socratic/seminar-style pedagogy in upper grades, plus a plan for integrating contemplative/scholé practices (restful learning, memory work, chant) as part of a weekly rhythm. Provide examples of upper-level seminars, debates, and structured rhetorical exercises with documented outcomes.
 - Element 5 (Faculty): Expand the “living curriculum” concept with more explicit faculty portraits, professional development plans centered on classical pedagogy, and a visible faculty handbook or charter that describes teacher ideals, virtues, and measurable formation targets.
 - Element 6 (Parents & Community): Create a recurring, public-facing calendar of parent formation opportunities (book studies, lectures, family liturgies or celebrations) and a clear, accessible path for open-campus visits and ongoing parental involvement that aligns with classical community expectations.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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